



Mistaken Identity?

CHANDIGARH The case of a top Haryana law officer allegedly attempting to bribe a judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court by sending her a home delivery of Rs 15 lakh has not only left the Bhupinder Singh Hooda Government red-faced, it has also touched off a storm in the legal circles of Chandigarh. The police

are looking for Sanjiv Bansal, an additional advocate-general of Haryana, who had the cash delivered to Justice Nirmaljit Kaur's house. She informed the police, suspecting it to be an attempt to bribe her. Bansal initially said that the cash was part of a land deal he had struck and his subordinate delivered it at the

HOME DELIVERY: Ram

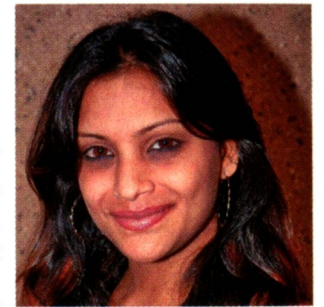
wrong address. The police, however, picked holes in his story and booked him and two others under the Prevention of Corruption Act. Bansal's subordinate Parkash Ram has been arrested.

Preliminary police investigations hinted that the audacious cash-to-judge attempt was made by Bansal to buy judicial reprieve for one of his high-profile clients facing a criminal case listed for hearing in the high court. Embarrassed by its law official's costly indiscretion, the Hooda Government is pressuring Bansal to submit his resignation on moral grounds. More skeletons may just tumble out of the closet in this murky home delivery bribe.

by Ramesh Vinayak

Criminal Intent

MUMBAI Three months after television executive Neeraj Grover's gruesome murder, the Mumbai Crime Branch has finally filed a chargesheet against Kannada actress Maria Susairaj and her accomplice Emile Jerome, a naval officer. Apart from statements by 94 witnesses, the 605-page chargesheet lists charges



CHARGED: Susairaj

of murder, criminal conspiracy and destroying evidence against the duo. The key documents filed include a confession by Susairaj and 10 statements recorded before a magistrate. "We have filed the chargesheet in the court and have sent copies to lawyers of Susairaj and Jerome," says Deven Bharti, additional commissioner of police, crime.

Grover was allegedly stabbed to death by Jerome in Susairaj's flat at Malad in May. The two are believed to have cut his body into pieces and disposed them of in the Manor jungle of Thane district. The chargesheet copies have also been sent to Susairaj and Jerome.

Even as Grover's parents wait for justice, lawyers say that the case could take up to a year to come up for hearing.

by Swati Mathur

Sops to Win

JAIPUR With the countdown to the state Assembly polls having begun, Chief Minister Vasundhara Raje is busy announcing sops. Her latest offering is a five-day week for state Government employees. She has also announced municipal corporation status for Bikaner and upgraded half-a-dozen panchayat samitis and local bodies in districts where the BJP has been losing ground. Raje recently granted municipal corporation status to Ajmer while constituting the Jodhpur Development Authority.

Raje also acceded to the long-pending demand of relaxing a candidate's

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



POLL FEVER: Raje

age criterion in case the Government fails to conduct direct recruitment for them, ordered regularisation of 28,000 para teachers and upped the retirement age in boards and corporations to 60 years from 58. She is also helping 50 lakh women from the weaker sections with an initial deposit of

Rs 1,500 to open a bank account. This is just the icing on the cake of the campaign that highlights her achievements through a state-specific slogan, "Jai Jai Rajasthan". It seems the maharani is not leaving any stone unturned to ensure a win in the coming polls.

by Rohit Parihar